

A vertical photograph on the left side of the page shows a person's arm and hand in a red shirt, standing next to a blackboard. The hand is resting on a ledge. The blackboard is dark and has some faint, illegible writing on it.

# India's **BEST** COLLEGES

| By Raj Chengappa |

In the pursuit of excellence, India's academia can learn from two iconic contemporary examples: US President Barack Obama and, surprise, T20 cricket. Obama, with his genius for inspiring both by word and deed, famously said: "Change will not come if we wait for some other person or some other time. We are the one's we've been waiting for. We are the change we seek."

Even if it may seem banal in comparison, T20 cricket does have some larger motivational lessons to impart than just sheer entertainment. As the ongoing battle for the World Cup shows, it's not reputation that matters but a team's performance on any given day. It's a game that every ball bowled and every shot played can make the difference. And it also shows that if a lowly ranked team fights hard enough it can upset the favourites.

AS INDIA TODAY unfurls the results of its 13th annual survey of academic excellence, those colleges and institutions that figure in the honours list will let out a cheer. Others

Photograph by NEHA NATH. Model: Parvati Puri. Courtesy: DRI. Modeling Agency: Make-up: Sanku Sharma. Location: Country House. DRI.